

RickyAI

Complete How-To Guide

Your step-by-step manual for mastering the 14-step business growth engine, 10 optimization layers, Video Studio, and community tools.

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1. Getting Started

Welcome to RickyAI — a business growth operating system that replaces dozens of disconnected tools with one unified platform.

Step 1: Create Your Account

- Visit the signup page and enter your name, email, and password.
- New users get a 7-day free trial — no credit card required.
- Check your email for a confirmation link. Click it to activate.

Step 2: Complete Onboarding

- After logging in, you'll be guided through the Profile setup (Step 2).
- Enter your business name, niche, audience, brand tone, and social URLs.
- This profile powers every AI recommendation in the system.

Step 3: Accept Terms of Service

- You'll be prompted to read and accept the Terms of Service before accessing the dashboard.

2. Understanding Your Plan

Plan	Price	Brands	Locations	Key Features
Creator	\$59/mo	1	1	8 core steps, basic Video Studio, BYOLLM
Business Starter	\$169/mo	1	2	Full 14 steps, Lead Scout, Campaign Blueprint
Growth	\$249/mo	5	5 each	Grant Search, marketplace selling, priority support
Agency	\$799/mo	25+	Unlimited	Team roles, cross-brand analytics
Enterprise	Custom	Unlimited	Unlimited	SSO, dedicated infra, custom onboarding

Nonprofit Discount: Registered 501(c)(3) organizations receive 15% off any tier. Email nonprofit@rickyai.com with your EIN.

No-Refund Policy: Cancel anytime, but no refunds are issued for the current billing period. Your access continues through the end of your paid cycle. Your billing date repeats on the same calendar day you first subscribed.

BYOLLM: Bring Your Own LLM — you provide API keys for premium AI features (OpenAI, Claude, Gemini, HeyGen, ElevenLabs). RickyAI never charges you for AI usage; you pay providers directly at their rates.

3. The 14-Step Growth Engine

Step 1: Connect

Link your social accounts (TikTok, Instagram, YouTube, Facebook, LinkedIn), automation tools (Make, n8n, Zapier), and data sources (Google Sheets/Drive). This is your control center.

Step 2: Profile

Define your business identity — name, niche, target audience, brand voice, competitors, services, and social URLs. This fuels every AI recommendation.

Step 3: Compete

Run competitive analysis. See how you stack up against competitors across SEO, GEO, AEO, and SGE visibility surfaces.

Step 4: Scout

Discover local conversations, trending topics, and content ideas relevant to your market. Get prompts and suggestions.

Step 5: Audit

Assess your online reputation — reviews, content gaps, consistency issues. Get scored by optimization layer.

Step 6: Platform

Get recommendations on which platforms to focus on, suggested posting frequency, and ideal content formats.

Step 7: Script

Generate scripts and posts with hooks and CTAs using your connected LLM or the built-in base model. Save scripts per campaign.

Step 8: Video Studio

Create videos using free tools (stock overlays, text animations), AI-assisted editing, or premium BYO tools (HeyGen, ElevenLabs, InVideo).

Step 9: Storyboard

Break videos into scene-by-scene outlines with text and visual notes. Ties into Script and Video Studio.

Step 10: Export

Export finished assets in correct formats (9:16, 16:9, 1:1) and download content calendars as ICS files.

Step 11: Lead Scout

Discover potential partners, leads, communities, and accounts to engage with in your market.

Step 12: Grant Search

Search and surface relevant grants and funding opportunities for your business or nonprofit. (Growth+ plans)

Step 13: Search Visibility

Track your presence across search surfaces — SEO, GEO, AEO, SGE — with scores and trend data.

Step 14: Campaign Blueprint

One-shot creation of full campaign plans: episodes, hooks, derivatives, posting rhythm, and platform specs.

4. 10 Optimization Layers Explained

RickyAI isn't just a visibility tool — it's a full business growth engine. Each layer is tracked on your dashboard with color-coded badges.

SEO — Search Engine Optimization

Traditional search rankings on Google, Bing, etc.

GEO — Generative Engine Optimization

Visibility in AI-generated search results and summaries.

AEO — Answer Engine Optimization

Getting featured in answer boxes, snippets, and voice search.

SGE — Search Generative Experience

Appearing in Google's AI-powered search overviews.

LMO — Local Market Optimization

Dominating your local area — maps, local search, community presence.

RMO — Reputation Management Optimization

Controlling how your brand appears in reviews, mentions, and sentiment.

CRO — Conversion Rate Optimization

Turning traffic into paying customers with optimized funnels and CTAs.

DMO — Data Monetization Optimization

Using audience insights and analytics to create new revenue opportunities.

CAO — Community Authority Optimization

Building trust and authority within your local community and industry.

PAO — Platform Amplification Optimization

Maximizing reach by tailoring content for each platform's algorithm.

5. Video Studio

Free Mode (No API Keys Needed)

- Use stock video overlays and text animations in the browser.
- Export in multiple aspect ratios (9:16, 16:9, 1:1, 4:5).
- Great for social media clips, announcements, and testimonials.

AI-Assisted Mode

- Uses built-in AI to suggest edits, generate captions, and recommend scenes.
- Connect your own LLM keys for enhanced script-to-video workflows.

Premium BYO Mode

- Connect HeyGen for AI avatar videos.
- Connect ElevenLabs for AI voiceovers.
- Works with InVideo, CapCut, Canva via export.
- You pay the providers directly — RickyAI charges \$0 for AI usage.

How to add your API keys:

1. Go to Step 1 (Connect) in the sidebar.
2. Scroll to 'API Keys' section.
3. Enter your provider key (e.g., OpenAI, HeyGen, ElevenLabs).
4. Keys are encrypted and stored securely. Only you can access them.

6. Automation & Webhooks

RickyAI connects to your automation tools so you can build end-to-end content pipelines.

Supported Tools: Make.com, n8n, Zapier, custom webhooks.

How It Works:

1. Go to Step 1 (Connect) → Webhooks section.
2. Paste your webhook URL from Make/n8n/Zapier.
3. Select the trigger type (e.g., 'Content Ready', 'Campaign Created').
4. RickyAI sends data to your webhook when events happen.
5. Your automation tool handles the rest — posting, scheduling, notifications.

Example Pipeline: Keyword → Research → Script → Voiceover → Video → Post to Sheets → Schedule via Make.

7. Community, Marketplace & Gamification

Community Forum

- Post questions, share wins, get feedback from other business owners.
- Categories include General, Strategy, Video, SEO, and more.
- Upvote helpful posts. Admins can pin important threads.

Strategy Marketplace

- Browse and buy proven strategies from other users.
- Growth+ plan users can sell their own strategies and earn revenue.
- Filter by industry, platform, location, and price.

Gamification

- Earn points for completing steps, posting in forums, and staying consistent.
- Build streaks by logging in daily.
- Level up and earn badges that show on your profile.
- Compete on the leaderboard with other members.

Affiliate Program

- Share your referral link and earn commissions on every conversion.
- Track clicks, conversions, and earnings in your dashboard.

8. Account Management & Billing

Managing Your Subscription

- Click 'Manage Subscription' in the dashboard to access the billing portal.
- Upgrade or downgrade your plan at any time.
- Changes take effect at the start of your next billing cycle.

Cancellation

- You may cancel anytime through the billing portal.
- No refunds are issued for the current billing period.
- Your access continues until the end of your paid cycle.
- Your billing date is the same calendar day each month (or year) as when you first subscribed.

Usage Tracking

- Monitor your video renders, AI tokens, and storage in the sidebar.
- Usage resets on the 1st of each month.

9. Admin Panel (For Team Leads)

Available to users with the 'admin' role. Access via the sidebar.

- **User Management:** View all users, assign roles (admin, moderator, developer, finance, marketing).
- **Ban Management:** Issue temporary or permanent bans for policy violations.
- **Content Flags:** Review reported content and take action.
- **Advertiser Management:** Manage in-app ad campaigns and placements.
- **Affiliate Payouts:** Review and process affiliate commission payouts.
- **Stats Dashboard:** View total users, active subscriptions, revenue metrics.

10. Troubleshooting & FAQ

Q: I can't log in after signing up.

A: Check your email for the confirmation link. You must verify your email before signing in.

Q: My trial expired. What happens?

A: You'll be prompted to select a paid plan. Your data is preserved — just subscribe to regain access.

Q: How do I connect my own AI keys?

A: Go to Step 1 (Connect) → API Keys section. Enter your key for OpenAI, HeyGen, ElevenLabs, etc.

Q: Can I use the app without any API keys?

A: Yes! The free Video Studio mode and built-in AI features work without any keys.

Q: How do I get the nonprofit discount?

A: Email nonprofit@rickyai.com with your organization's EIN. We'll send a 15% discount code.

Q: Can I switch plans?

A: Yes — use the 'Manage Subscription' button to upgrade or downgrade anytime.

Q: Where is my data stored?

A: All data is stored securely with row-level security. Only you can see your own business data.

Q: How do I export my content calendar?

A: Go to Step 10 (Export) and click the calendar export button to download an ICS file.

Q: What if I need more than 25 brands?

A: Contact sales@rickyai.com for an Enterprise plan with unlimited brands and custom pricing.

Need more help? Visit the Community Forum inside the app or email support@rickyai.com.